CS 2340 Term Project User Manual - Preston Crowe

Step (1) - Decompress ZIP And Prep Files

Download the ZIP file from the submission and move it into a preferred spot on your computer file directory. Unzip the files.

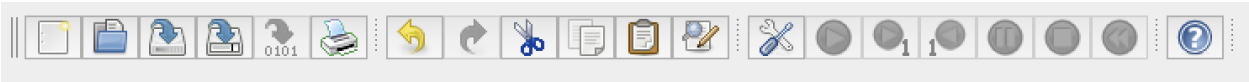
Step (2) - Opening MARS And .ASM Files

This manual assumes that you have already installed MARS MIPS and have the correct version as per CS 2340.001 at UT Dallas.

Find the “Mars4_5.jar” file on your computer. Once you double click to open, you should be able to see “File” > “Open”. Find the directory you put the ZIP file in, and look for the folder called “TermProject_Preston_Crowe”. In that folder, you must select “main.asm” to open. You can optionally open up multiple files to see the code if you are curious.

Step (3) - Running The Program

On the top of the MARS window, you should see a tool bar with many different icons



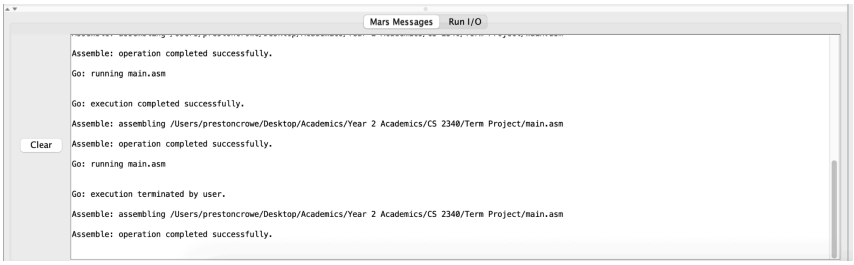
^ here!

The icon pointed out should be pressed when you are viewing the main.asm file (it is very important that the file selected is the main.asm file). This icon once clicked will compile the program. Once the program is successfully compiled, you must click play:



^ here!

The green play button (not the one with a one on it) will start the program after it was compiled. You should be able to see a “Run I/O” section on the most bottom window in the main MARS frame as shown below:



The program should automatically take you to the “Run I/O” section after the green button has been pressed.

Step (4) - Game Control

Once you actually play the game, you should see a welcome screen that says “WELCOME TO NUMBER CHAIN!” Wait until you are prompted to input anything to the screen. After the main music theme plays, you should see the randomization of which player goes first and eventually be prompted for the grid spot you want to occupy.

Every time you input, remember that it is a 2-character input that will automatically press enter for you ($a1 parameter of the SysReadString syscall), where the first character is a character A-F that represents the column (uppercase or lowercase will work). The second character is the row number in the 1-6 scale. As long as you follow that format, you will not need to be prompted again for a different input.

Once the game is complete, the program will safely exit on its own, therefore no user action is needed after you hear the music theme and see what the console says as to who won.